

# Dhāraṇī of Avalokiteśvara

Avalokiteśvaradhāraṇī · Toh 704 · Derge Kangyur

Toh 704 in the Kangyur is a short dhāraṇī text devoted to the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, known in Tibetan as Phags pa spyen ras gzigs dbang phyug, and belonging to the broader Sanskrit dhāraṇī literature associated with this deity. The text centers on a ritual dhāraṇī formula invoking Avalokiteśvara's great compassion, accompanied by practical instructions for its application: the arrangement of maṇḍalas, the recitation of the mantra a prescribed number of times, and the anointing of a sick person, all directed toward the healing and pacification of illness. It specifies conditions and time frames for the rite's efficacy, including the caveat that those who have committed the five acts of immediate retribution may not achieve the desired result. The text was translated into Tibetan by the translation-scholar Śerab Jungne, and it belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur, representing the canonical genre of short ritual and mantra texts associated with great bodhisattvas.

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Translated, edited, and finalized by the translation-scholar Śerab Jungne.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the noble Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva, the great being, the one of great compassion. The dhāraṇī is as follows:

Oṃ akaṭe vikaṭe nikaṭe kataṃkaṭe karoṭe karoṭa vīrye svāhā.

Without the heavy soil in front of the Blessed One falling to the ground, one arranges eight maṇḍalas separately, and recites the mantra up to thirteen times over each maṇḍala. Then, with the remaining mantra recitation, one anoints the sick person nearby, and all illnesses will be pacified.

This will be accomplished in seven days, or thirteen days, or twenty-one days — provided one has not committed any of the five acts of immediate retribution (ānantarya). If it has not been accomplished in that way, it means that one has committed one of the five acts of immediate retribution.

The Dhāraṇī of the Lion's Roar is complete.

From the Indian master...

## Translator's Notes

- The text breaks off mid-sentence with "From the Indian master" — the Tibetan reads only "rgya gar gyi mkhan" without completing the name or colophon, suggesting the passage as

given is incomplete at the end.

The phrase rendered "without the heavy soil in front of the Blessed One falling to the ground" is the standard ritual instruction meaning that the maṇḍala offering material (here lci ba, "heavy" or "weighty" material, likely sand or earth used for the maṇḍala) should be arranged before the image of the Blessed One without any being spilled; this is a purity-of-performance stipulation, not a miraculous event.

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## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.